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NOLS Hiring Team

National Outdoor Leadership School

RE: MARKETING MANAGER

Dear NOLS Hiring Team,

I'm writing to apply for the Marketing Manager role. Most marketing candidates for a wilderness school have to pick a lane — the campaign-and-analytics side, or the genuine-outdoor-credibility side. **I don't have to pick.** I've spent fifteen years running integrated marketing campaigns, and just as long actually teaching and working in the backcountry.

The wilderness-education half isn't recent. I spent my junior year of high school at the High Mountain Institute, worked trails and outdoor camps throughout college, taught whitewater canoeing, backpacking, and trail maintenance as an instructor in Colgate's Outdoor Education Program, and coach mountain biking today as a PMBIA-certified coach. "Elevating the Leader in Everyone" isn't language I'm learning for this application — it's language I recognize from the inside.

The marketing half is fifteen years of building and running integrated campaigns. As Head of Marketing Technology at Teren, I built persona-driven campaigns that quadrupled qualified leads. As Marketing Automation Manager at Zayo Group, I owned the Salesforce marketing stack — Einstein and Marketing Cloud — and helped lift lead conversion 15% through lead scoring and process automation. At Homebot, I built the email product that got millions of homeowners to actually open and act on communications. **The throughline is the same every time: turn data into a campaign decision, then turn that decision into a story someone reads.**

On the analytics side, I work in Google Analytics and have hands-on Looker Studio experience, on top of dashboards and reporting that have been constant across my career — customer segmentation at Lytics, lead-scoring models at Zayo, custom dashboards for National Park Service staff. On content strategy, I'm going deep right now on AEO (Answer Engine Optimization) — the direction SEO is actually heading as search shifts toward AI answer engines. I'm also used to being the connective tissue between marketing and the rest of an organization — partnering cross-functionally across engineering, product, and sales at Teren, and managing vendor and stakeholder relationships directly at a small retail business more recently.

I've spent much of my career gravitating toward mission-driven organizations — conservation-nonprofit roots in college, and current advisory work at a small water-utility startup. Marketing for an organization I actually believe in, instead of talking myself into a product, is exactly the kind of work I'm looking for. I'm based in Boulder, Colorado, one of NOLS's remote-eligible states, and I'd welcome the chance to complete a NOLS course early on — I can't think of a better way to learn the product I'd be marketing.

Thank you for considering my application. I'd love the opportunity to talk about how my marketing background and lifelong relationship with wilderness education could support NOLS's enrollment and brand goals.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

BOULDER, COLORADO